

members in attendance. This year we held six regional pre-Conferences throughout our area so the groups could have the opportunity to be more involved in the Conference topics and so I could be better prepared for the Conference. We have roughly 400 to 500 members attending these regional pre-Conferences each year. Our area is currently looking into how to fund interpreters for Spanish members and the hearing impaired at our area assemblies and other events. We have formed an area Web site, which will be coming this summer. And we have been working on a revision of our area history book, "Our Stories Disclosed" and the updated book will contain information from about 600 of our groups. — *Eddie Harris*

**West Virginia:** Area 73 has approximately 300 groups in 16 districts. We have an assembly each spring and fall, which is offered to every district to host in a regular rotation. In the summer we have an area-wide convention that is also on a rotation. The cooperation among the districts is successful, and all districts are active. Our area elections use the Third Legacy procedure. Any one who has served on our area committee is eligible to offer themselves for any of the area committee positions. The chair positions of P.I., C.P.C., Corrections, Hospital and Treatment, Grapevine and Literature are nominated by their district. Our delegate always visits the districts to give a report after each Conference. We have an 800 phone number in all the state directories, which receives around 250 calls per month, mostly people looking for a meeting but occasionally an alcoholic reaching out. Our Web site allows a person to look up a meeting anywhere in the state or check for upcoming events. Area 73 is currently struggling with problems like: keeping personalities out of A.A. service work; sloth and procrastination; ego and self-centeredness. I believe it was this way when Area 73 was formed and I believe it will be this way 100 years from now. I believe there will be an Area 73 one hundred years from now because I believe in alcoholism and I believe in God and I believe that we are progressing in Area 73. Come by sometime and trudge the road with us. God bless you all. — *Jerry Moore*.

**Wisconsin (Southern):** Area 75 has 950 active groups served by 32 districts. District 10 is an at-large district that serves all Spanish-speaking groups. We have our own translation equipment. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies per year. An annual delegates workshop is held to create a balanced "informed group conscience" to carry to the General Service Conference. Past delegates continue to provide a "traveling G.S.R. school" for anyone that requests it. They also hold a G.S.R. school at the first agenda planning meeting of each year. Southern Wisconsin actively carries the A.A. message into correctional facilities, utilizing our "Rainbow Can" donations to purchase Conference-approved A.A. literature and our "Count on Us" program to provide hundreds of Grapevine subscriptions for the inside meetings. We, along with Area 74 (Northern Wisconsin and the UP of Michigan), hold an annual Corrections conference to coordinate BTG and volunteer efforts between Area 74 and Area 75. Our Third Annual Unity Conference will be held in July. This joint effort focuses on sharing information between Areas 74 and 75, with the ongoing theme of "Recovery, Unity and Service." This conference is held in addition to our long-standing Area 75 spring and fall conferences. Our alternate delegate is now funded to attend the Delegates/Past Delegates Conference. Our P.I. chairperson launched our Web site this year. My personal goals for this rotation are to bring the "dark districts" back into our service structure and to help the groups provide accurate information to G.S.O. to update our directories. — *Jo McLaughlin*

## Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

### AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the question under the category "Pre-Conference" which reads, "Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate and timely, ( ) Yes ( ) No" be replaced with the following two questions:

a) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate?  
( ) Yes ( ) No

b) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. timely?  
( ) Yes ( ) No

- The committee also suggested that the parenthetical explanation "(e.g. schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.)" be added to the sentence for item 7, which would then read:

"If you have suggestions for improving the Conference (e.g., schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.), please list them here:"

### ARCHIVES<sup>1</sup>

- The committee reviewed the updates suggested by the trustees' Archives Committee to be included in the next reprint of the Archives Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider additional items in the "Mission Statement" and in the "Calendar of Holdings" of the Workbook.

### COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

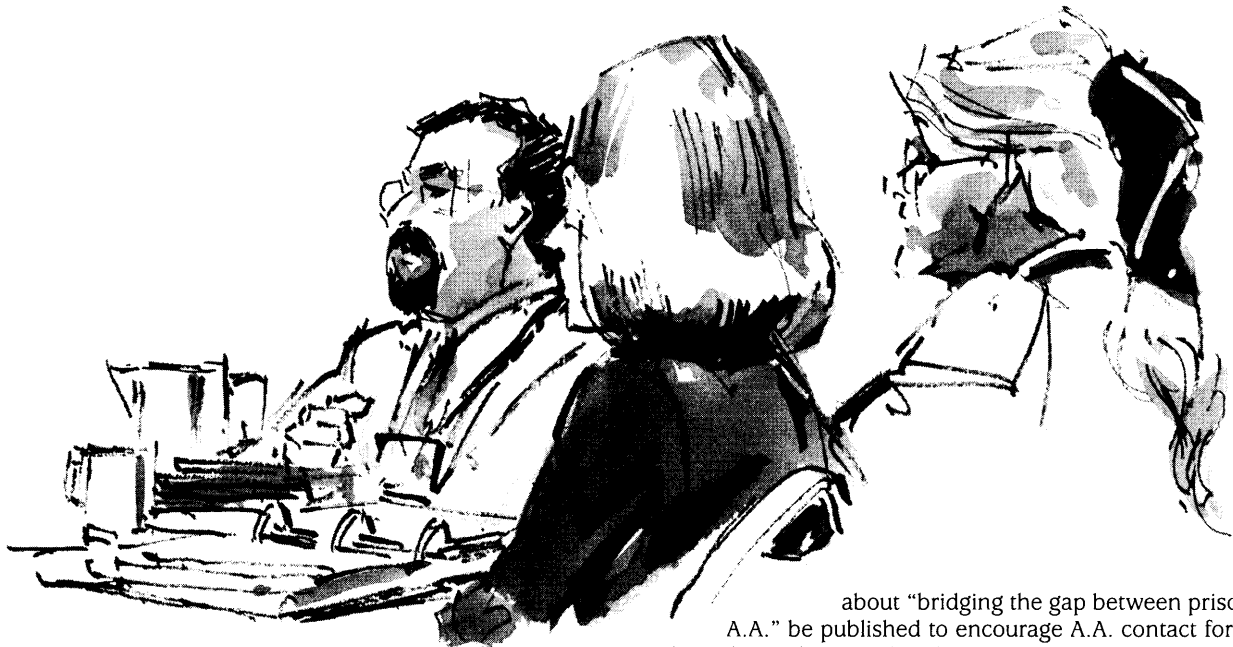
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee regarding new C.P.C. displays, and thanked the trustees' committee and the Publications Department for developing new tabletop displays for A.A. exhibits at national professional conferences.

The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider providing delegate areas with equal opportunities to obtain the current C.P.C. displays, once the new displays are available.

- The committee considered the request that the Workbook (service material) be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee; that changes to the workbook be approved by the trustees' committee; that any changes to the workbook be reported annually to the Conference Committee, and distributed as background material, and reaffirmed the sense of the 1999 C.P.C. committee that "...as service material the Kit and Workbook could be updated as often as shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Workbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee."

- The committee discussed ways of reaching a wider variety of professionals, and suggested that we: 1) continue to reach out

<sup>1</sup>Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



to nursing and medical schools; 2) consider assigning an A.A. "sponsor" to professionals or students who come to A.A. meetings, sitting with them and helping them understand the meeting as it progresses; 3) make more frequent use of "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous;" 4) carry the message through calls or personal contacts to professionals, in addition to mailings; 5) cooperate with other service committees to reach professionals in all fields.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities reconsider development of a Conference-approved pamphlet similar to the local flyers entitled "So the Court Sent You to A.A. and You Hate the Idea," and that the committee's secretary seek wider input from the delegate areas on the need for such a pamphlet.

- The committee requested that the secretary convey their concerns regarding certain editorial corrections to the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to the secretary to the trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees.

#### CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee accepted with appreciation the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' suggestion to combine the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook in a single three-ring binder format with the suggested title of "Correctional Facilities Kit;" and that the Workbook also be available as a separate item.

- The committee unanimously suggested that the pamphlet "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" (P-43) be added to the Correctional Facilities Kit.

- The committee reviewed the draft statement of purpose developed by the trustees' Committee for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and took no action.

- The committee reviewed the draft statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and requested that this topic be considered by the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities because the statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose is under review by another 2003 Conference committee.

- The committee also considered a request that a pamphlet

about "bridging the gap between prisons and A.A." be published to encourage A.A. contact for newly-released members, and took no action.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities gather examples of local A.A. pre-release brochures and/or forms and develop generic samples to be considered by the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for possible inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

#### FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Committee and amended item 1 under the Scope to read "Reviews the A.A. World Services/General Service Board budget and financial reports" (it had read only the A.A. World Services budget).

- The committee reviewed the reporting of International Convention accounting on the 2002 financial statements and looked favorably on the balance sheet treatment (a separate column for an International Convention Fund). However, it felt that the footnote listing all prior conventions with profits and losses was too detailed. The committee indicated an abbreviated footnote was more appropriate, for example:

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the Balance Sheet represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include such items as site selection costs, deposits on facilities, and professional management expenses. Following established Policy, funds not needed for current operations reside in the Reserve Fund.

- The committee reviewed the draft of the "Simplified Reserve Fund" document forwarded by the trustees' Finance Committee.

- The committee then reviewed the current A.A. Finance Guidelines as well as the current version of *The A.A. Service Manual*, and felt those descriptions better fulfilled the intent of last year's committee for a simplified description of the Reserve Fund.

- The committee also suggested that the document forwarded by the trustees' Finance Committee be available if a request for more detailed information is requested by a member of the Fellowship.

- After considerable discussion on the topic of self-support, the committee feels that sponsorship is the key. The committee urges the delegates to discuss financial responsibility within their areas.

## GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for Grapevine items to be produced in the year 2004 or later and unanimously agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the following items to be developed: Victor E. posters in English, French, and Spanish, celebrating the A.A. Grapevine's 60<sup>th</sup> anniversary, and a Spanish-language edition of *The Best of Bill*.

- By a substantial majority, the committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board suggestions that the following items be developed: French, Spanish, and English-language editions of a pocket-sized soft-cover collection of Grapevine stories focusing on A.A.'s Responsibility Declaration, titled *I Am Responsible*; and a new Spanish-language audio CD of stories previously published in La Viña.

- The committee expressed deep concern about information from the Grapevine Board received during the committee meeting that the board had failed to observe the 1993 Conference Advisory Action stating: "The Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."

Following lengthy discussion, the committee strongly suggests that the Grapevine Corporate Board:

1. Establish a one-year moratorium on initiating the sale of Grapevine items, including the Grapevine magazine, to any enterprise not identified as an A.A. entity.
2. Outline the sequence of events, meetings and decisions, as well as the rationale, that led to the Grapevine magazine being sold through an enterprise not identified as an A.A. entity.
3. Provide a full report on the history of the 1993 Advisory Action, including the concerns that led to that Action, as well as the meaning and intent of that Action.
4. Provide to the committee an interim report on the three points above no later than September 30, 2003, followed by a final report to be sent as background to the 2004 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.

- The committee also strongly suggests that the Grapevine Corporate Board carefully review Conference Advisory Actions prior to implementing a practice or policy.

## INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS<sup>1</sup>

- The committee discussed data collecting of personal information of A.A. members who attend conventions and strongly suggested that, in order to protect A.A.'s principle of anonymity, G.S.O. direct hotels contracted for Regional Forums and International Conventions not to use the list of A.A. hotel guests in conjunction with the words "Alcoholics Anonymous" or "A.A." for any mailing lists including outside marketing campaigns.

- The committee discussed ways to improve and encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested:

Continue providing simultaneous translations into Spanish and/or French to increase participation of Spanish- and French-speaking A.A. members.

Have presentations at Forums in Spanish and French as well as English.

Seek better ways to encourage members, groups, districts and areas in organizing various means of transportation to Regional/Special Forums.

Encourage attendees to share their Forum experience more widely with other members, (e.g. articles in local newsletters, reports at group conscience or business meetings, etc.).

## LITERATURE

- The committee encourages full Conference discussion of the A.A. World Services Board's "intent to place the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the G.S.O. Web site."

- After lengthy discussion, the committee considered the request to edit the following Fourth Edition Big Book stories to restore their Third Edition Big Book content: "The Housewife Who Drank At Home," "Me An Alcoholic?," "Another Chance" and "Freedom From Bondage," and agreed to accept the Fourth Edition Big Book editorial changes and agreed to take no action.

## POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the request to form a secondary General Service Conference Committee to review all aspects of G.S.O. Internet usage and make recommendations for additions, changes and/or improvements, and agreed there was no widely expressed need for such a committee.

- The committee discussed the request to establish an ad hoc committee of trustees, delegates and staff to outline the means and criteria for examining material submitted for Conference approval and took no action.

- The committee discussed the request to form a Conference Committee on Special Needs and agreed that Special Needs in the Fellowship are currently being met by the existing services provided by A.A. World Services and the General Service Office.

## PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook. They suggested that the pamphlets "Is A.A. for Me?" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic" be added to the Kit.

- The committee also considered the request that the Workbook (service material) be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee; that changes to the Workbook be approved by the trustees' committee; that any changes to the Workbook be reported annually to the Conference Committee, and distributed as background material and took no action.

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "Reach Out" P.S.A.

- The committee requested that a copy of the updated version of the Compilation Video of PSAs (VS-28) be mailed to all area P.I. Committee chairs.

- The committee suggested that television public service announcement inventory item #TV-17 ("Female" and "Information") be removed from inventory. Inventory item #TV-17 has the lowest circulation of all current P.S.A.s.

<sup>1</sup>Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

## REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered that Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. on page S23 be returned to the text on pages S45-49 in the 1991-1992 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* that includes the sections "How Elected," "What is an A.A. Group," "How the A.A. Group Fits into the Structure of the Fellowship," "The A.A. Group – the Final Voice of the Fellowship," "Why Do We Need Service Entities Other Than the A.A. Group," "How Much Organization Should an A.A. Group Have?" and "The Home Group," and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the updated chart of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. to replace the chart on page S80 and other editorial updates to include language on the Grapevine Representative (GvR), La Viña Representative (RLV) and La Viña.
- The committee considered the request that the trustees conduct an audit of all reported Conference Advisory Actions to ensure that they have been and will be reported accurately and took no action.
- The committee discussed the purpose and usefulness of the Eastern and Western, Canada A.A. Directories, and International A.A. Directory and agreed that the directories continue to be useful and serve the Fellowship.

## TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee expressed appreciation for the work of the trustees' Committee and the Publications Department on combining the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit, and unanimously requested that:

The Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit be available as a single unit in a 3-ring binder, with the suggested title "Treatment Facilities Kit";

The reformatted soft-cover Treatment Facilities Workbook, bound in 8 ½ X 11 format and 3-hole punched be included in the Kit; and, that the reformatted Workbook also be available as a separate item.

- The committee requested that the combined Treatment Facilities Kit continue to be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, the trustees' Committee review changes in content, and the Conference Committee continue to be advised of any changes.
- The committee also reviewed the contents of the reformatted Treatment Facilities Kit, and suggested streamlining the divider tabs, as well as reducing the pamphlets and service material to be included.

## TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/Canada.
- The committee discussed various ways to encourage qualified and willing nonalcoholic "friends of the Fellowship" to serve as Class A trustees, including posting vacancy announcements in area, district and intergroup newsletters, as well as on local A.A. Web sites. The committee also suggested that A.A. members work closely with potential candidates to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous and the role and responsibilities of Class A trustees.

- The committee reviewed a request that the Conference examine the role and responsibilities of regional trustees, and develop a means for their selection to provide substantially more input from the areas within a given region. Following a lengthy discussion on the roles and responsibilities of regional trustees, the committee unanimously agreed that no changes to the current procedures be made.

## RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

### CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- That changes to the Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit shall be reported annually to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities and distributed as background material. The Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit will continue to be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.

### LITERATURE

- That the following changes to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be approved:

1. On page 23, in the section "*What trusted servants (officers) do we need?*", the word "jobs" in the first sentence of the first paragraph be replaced with the word "service" and the word "jobs" in the first sentence of the third paragraph be replaced with "service positions."

2. The sentence "See the chart of *suggested group officers*," which introduces the Group Service Structure Chart on page 24 be replaced by the sentence "The chart below offers possibilities for service at the group level."

3. The sentence "Some groups have positions that do not appear on this chart such as greeter, archivist, special needs representative and liaison to meeting facility" be added immediately after the chart on page 24.

4. The reference to "Archives Representative" be deleted in the Group Service Structure Chart on page 24.

- That the Third Edition Big Book punctuation in "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" be restored based on the 1995 Conference Advisory Action: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices remain as is."

## REPORT AND CHARTER

- To add the words "and a sponsor" to the sentence of the second bullet under the section titled "Qualifications" in Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. in *The A.A. Service Manual* to read: "Usually, prospective G.S.R.s have at least two years of continuous sobriety and a sponsor."

Jutta Matthews (Alabama/NW Florida), on the Conference Grapevine Committee, brought special necklaces, sporting bunches of grapes, for each member of the committee.